

Review

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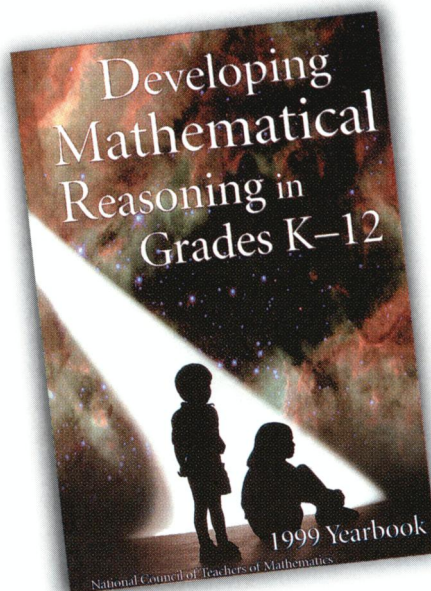
DEVELOPING MATHEMATICAL REASONING IN GRADES K–12, 1999 YEARBOOK

Lee V. Stiff, ed., 1999. 288 pp., \$25 cloth. National Council of Teachers of Mathematics, 1906 Association Dr., Reston, VA 20191-9988, (800) 235-7566.

NCTM's 1999 Yearbook offers excellent guidance for understanding and fostering mathematical reasoning. *Developing Mathematical Reasoning in Grades K–12* addresses different perspectives on the nature of reasoning, gathering evidence of student reasoning, various tasks that elicit student reasoning, and examples of how communication promotes reasoning.

Among the greatest strengths of this

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publication are the many learning and assessment activities that can be applied in the classroom. Teachers should use these activities with their own students and compare their responses with the observations in the yearbook. Indeed, teachers may also wonder, as I did, whether traditional forms of assessment received enough attention in the yearbook. Well-constructed traditional types of assessment can provide valuable information about students' reasoning that can be helpful in determining instructional methods.

Experienced mathematics educators will recognize many of the recommended instructional methods and assessment techniques as those that have long been encouraged in the profession. These articles provide renewed stimulation for continuing those practices. In addition, the collection emphasizes the links among instructional strategies, assessments, and curriculum, which must be maintained in practice in the classroom. Newly employed mathematics educators of grades K–12 stu-

dents will benefit greatly from the discussions of various assessment techniques useful for determining students' abilities to reason mathematically. The assessment information will help these teachers facilitate and improve students' mathematical reasoning. Finally, mathematics methods instructors will find it beneficial to have future teachers review, discuss, and critique some of the articles in this yearbook.—*Tuiren A. Bratina, University of North Florida, Jacksonville, FL 32224.*

MAKING CHANGE IN MATHEMATICS EDUCATION: LEARNING FROM THE FIELD

Joan Ferrini-Mundy, Karen Graham, Loren Johnson, and Geoffrey Mills, eds., 1998. xii + 148 pp., \$10.95 paper. ISBN 0-87353-442-5. National Council of Teachers of Mathematics, 1906 Association Dr., Reston, VA 20191-9988, (800) 235-7566.

This book provides information about how various school districts have made Standards-based changes in their mathematics curricula. The NCTM *Evaluation Standards* was the primary source used in implementing mathematics standards for all the districts. Through examples, the reader is given opportunities to reflect on "what works" and "what does not work" in implementing changes. The book is for mathematics educators, instructional leaders, and mathematics support specialists who are looking for ways to implement Standards-based reform in mathematics education. The findings reported suggest that a Standards-based program is effective in serving students in a variety of educational settings and in schools that serve diverse socioeconomic student populations.—*Hazel Russell, Fort Worth*